Mark Lorenze Ponciano

Finance Systems and Automation Specialist

Remote, Philippines (GMT+8) | marklorenzeponciano@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/mark-lorenze-ponciano-075271278 | markponciano.github.io

SUMMARY

I build the systems finance runs on, with a bookkeeper's accuracy: databases, integrations, monitoring and the screens teams work from. Three years in the books taught me where numbers go wrong; in 2026 I designed and ran a live booking and invoicing system connecting six tools to one database. Open to full-time, part-time and project work.

SKILLS

Systems and data: MySQL schema design, SQL, PHP, JavaScript and Node, Google Apps Script, Git and GitHub, AI-assisted development

Integrations: Xero API (OAuth), GoHighLevel API, webhooks with HMAC signing, WordPress, Brevo, CloudConvert, Google Calendar, Make

Reliability: Monitoring and alerting, scheduled reconciliation, audit logs, role-based access, staged releases with rollback

Finance: Xero (Certified Professional, Level 2), Dext (Certified Expert), reconciliation, accounts payable, payroll, reporting

EXPERIENCE

Systems and Automation Manager, also bookkeeper, UK events caterer and its sister restaurant (remote)
Feb 2026 to Oct 2026

- Designed and built the booking system the business runs on, in PHP and JavaScript: a MySQL database as the single record, with GoHighLevel, WordPress, Xero, Google Calendar, Brevo and CloudConvert all updating from it. Booking stages are derived from events, never typed in.
- Connected Xero over OAuth with rotating refresh tokens, so invoices raise and payments confirm automatically from the booking record.
- Built an operator console for the sales team: four steps in order and no action that can break a quote. The approved total is the invoiced total, and every action is logged with who took it.
- Built monitoring for connections, email delivery and automations, with plain-English alerts by severity and an outside service checking that the checks still run.
- Moved the live booking system onto the new build in one evening after about 130 checks, every step reversible in under a minute, with the team trained first. No downtime.
- Automated matchday payroll in Google Apps Script: one name per worker, duplicate shifts caught, hours checked against the posted rota, pay built overnight. Replaced a whole morning of checking after every game.
- Found about £80,000 a year missing from the weekly profit report by reconciling its cost settings against Xero; profit had been overstated by the same amount.

Bookkeeper, GP Bookkeeper, placed with a multi-practitioner medical clinic in Australia (remote)
Jan 2025 to Dec 2025

- Built a reconciliation engine in Google Apps Script: about 80% matched automatically, 15% needed a quick confirmation and 5% went to a person. A month of matching by hand became a Monday morning.
- Reconciled about 15,000 transaction lines a month from Best Practice against payments received, across nine payment types with no shared ID (Medicare, DVA, WorkCover, HICAPS, EFT, card, cash and more).
- Identified about A$8,000 in double payments to providers that the clinic knew about but couldn't trace, by cross-checking a year of reports, and recovered it in small weekly instalments.

Assistant Bookkeeper, Australian hospitality group, five cafes (remote)
Jan 2023 to Jun 2024

- Routed supplier bills automatically from the shared mailboxes to the right cafe's Xero, with rules specific to each organisation, cutting 15 to 25 manual entries a day.

CERTIFICATIONS AND EDUCATION

Xero Certified Professional, Level 2 | Dext Certified Expert (both Jan 2026)

BSc Psychology, New Era University, Philippines (2024). Concentration in quantitative research and statistical analysis.